EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A broad 2020 contraction

Findings from a selected 57-country fact sheet

COUNTRIES	GDP DECLINES	MEDIAN GROWTH	POPULATION
57	45 / 55	-4.02%	6.20bn
selected sample	observed growth	country median	sample total

The central finding

GDP growth is available for 55 countries. Forty-five recorded a contraction, while ten recorded positive growth. The median country posted a 4.02% decline. These are results for the supplied selection, not a world growth estimate.

What the data can show

The file combines population, economic, financial, digital and human-capital indicators in one cross-section. It supports comparisons across included countries and exploration of associations. It cannot establish a time trend or a causal explanation for 2020 outcomes.

Scope note. The CSV contains no explicit year field, extraction date or country-selection rule. The requester described it as a 2020 World Bank fact sheet. The 6.20 billion population sum refers only to the 57 included countries.

Key interpretation

GDP per capita and the human capital index have a strong rank association in this sample (Spearman rho = 0.879, n = 55). This is descriptive evidence, not a causal result. Missing values vary widely across indicators and are left missing throughout the project.

ECONOMIC OUTCOMES

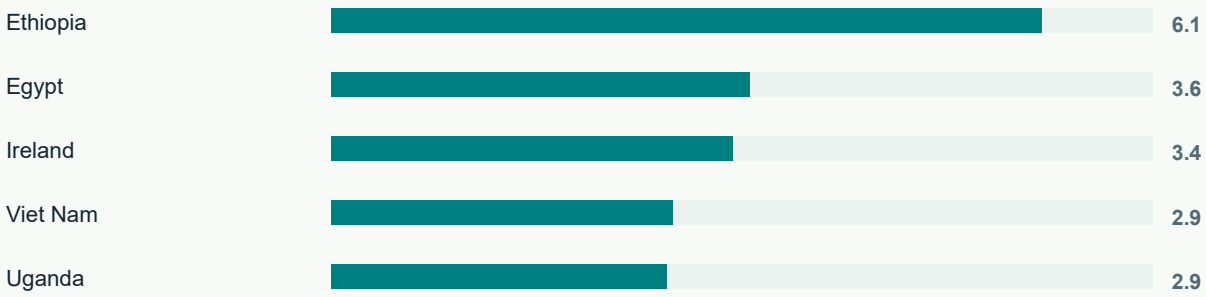
Economic outcomes varied

Annual GDP growth among countries with data

DEEPEST REPORTED CONTRACTIONS



HIGHEST REPORTED GROWTH



Beyond the headline

The country-level median is -4.02%. The reported final consumption expenditure share has a median of 75.54% among 48 countries with values. That measure includes more than household spending and should not be read as a direct account of consumer behavior. GDP growth is defined by the World Bank as an annual percentage change in real output based on constant local currency.

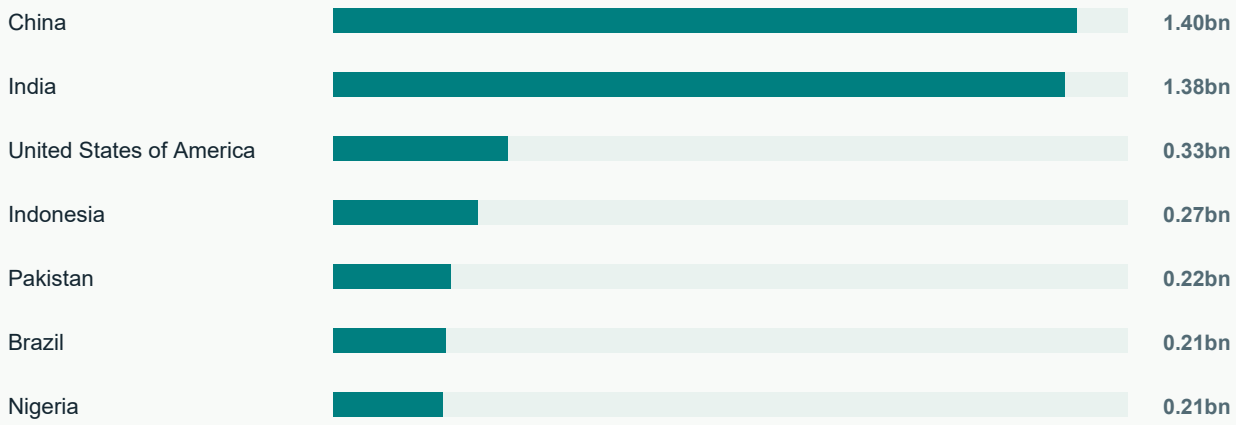
Japan and the United Arab Emirates have no GDP growth value in this CSV. Their absence from the growth rankings is a missing-data issue, not evidence of zero growth.

POPULATION AND DEVELOPMENT

Population shapes the sample

Different weighting choices answer different questions

LARGEST POPULATIONS IN THE SUPPLIED FILE



China and India together account for 44.9% of population in this 57-country sample. The population-weighted urban share of the sample is 56.4%. Both figures depend on which countries are included and must not be labeled global estimates.

GDP per capita and human capital

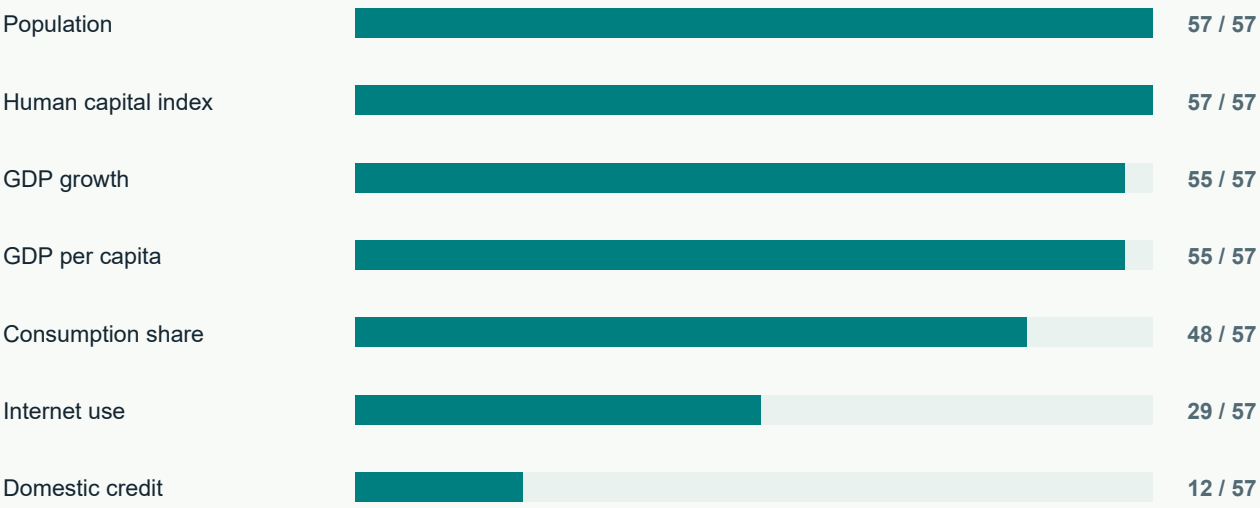
GDP per capita is present for 55 countries, with a median of $9,322 in constant 2010 US dollars. The top five observed values are Norway ($90,885), Ireland ($81,297), Switzerland ($80,132), Denmark ($63,880) and Singapore ($56,349). The human capital index median is 0.629 across all 57 countries.

The rank correlation between GDP per capita and HCI is 0.879 across 55 complete country pairs. This strong positive association does not account for confounding factors or reveal direction of influence. GDP per capita is output per person, not median income or a purchasing-power-adjusted welfare measure.

DATA QUALITY AND METHODS

Coverage is uneven

Observed country values out of 57



Method and validation

Empty cells are treated as missing, never zero. Country medians are unweighted. Urban share divides summed urban population by summed total population. Spearman rho uses complete country pairs. The population sex components reconcile exactly in every row; age dependency components reconcile within floating-point rounding. These arithmetic checks do not verify extraction provenance.

Limitations

The CSV lacks a year column, extraction vintage, series IDs and country-selection rule. Region labels are uneven and several groups have just one country. Current World Bank metadata can use newer base years; this analysis preserves the supplied constant 2010 US dollar labels. Comparisons are descriptive and should not be interpreted causally.

Source and reproducibility

Source: supplied final_demographics_data.csv, credited by the requester to data.worldbank.org. Rebuild: scripts/build_data.py. Detailed methods, indicator metadata links and limitations: analysis/report.md and analysis/methodology.md.

VERDICT AND RECOMMENDATIONS

What the evidence supports

Research verdict and priorities for next analysis

RESEARCH VERDICT

The selected countries show a broad output contraction in the supplied 2020 snapshot. Development levels and population scale vary sharply. The file supports descriptive sample comparisons; undocumented country selection, missing observation dates and uneven coverage prevent defensible world-level or causal conclusions.

01 Label the denominator

Show the number of observed countries for each statistic. Distinguish country medians from population-weighted shares and label every total as a sample total.

02 Prefer stronger coverage

Use population, HCI, GDP growth and GDP per capita for broad comparisons. Treat internet use (29 values) and domestic credit (12 values) as limited exploratory subsets.

03 Recover provenance

Confirm the original extraction date, World Bank series IDs, observation years and country-selection rule. Keep the supplied constant 2010 US dollar basis visible.

04 Build a time series before inference

Obtain a documented multi-year panel to assess pre-2020 levels and later recovery. Test sensitivity to country weighting and influential observations before policy use.

Full methods, detailed country tables and source links are in analysis/report.md. The interactive dashboard recalculates views after filtering and preserves missing values.